particularly stand out in this regard: the peace gesture by Prime Minister Imran Khan's government to India when it returned their pilot Wing Commander Abhinandan Varthaman, and the prime minister's visit to the United States to meet President Trump in order to restore relations between the two allies. Varthaman's fighter jet was shot down in February 2019 when Indian jets bombed what they claimed to be a rebel camp inside Pakistani territory, a claim Pakistan denied. As a peace gesture, the Pakistani government returned the Indian pilot, with Imran Khan reiterating his call for talks and improving relations with India. In July 2019, Imran Khan led a seemingly successful meeting with President Trump who 'spoke of possibly restoring $1.3 billion in American aid that he had cut last year, depending upon the results of the meeting, and offered to mediate in the longstanding dispute between Pakistan and India over the Kashmir region' (Rampton and Chiacu 2019). Both Pakistan's chief of army staff (COAS) and Pakistan's intelligence chief accompanied Khan, presenting a united front to the United States. This attempt at rekindling old alliances has resulted in the prime minister clearly stating that his government will no longer allow 'armed militias to operate', on Pakistani soil. While one may see some truth in this statement, with the arrest of Hafiz Saeed, and the crackdown on the TLP, Pakistan's history has clearly illustrated how the security state often backtracks on such actions.

Given the state of affairs one year on, where is the youth of Pakistan in the policy of the PTI government? With budget cuts to higher education and record-level inflation, the need for quality education and for jobs that young Pakistanis demanded are far from being met. In a July 2019 poll on public opinion about the PTI government by Gallup Pakistan, which included 1,400 households across the country, the approval rating of Imran Khan had dropped 'from 58% in April 2019 to 45%' after the announcement of the Budget for 2019. However, the same poll highlights how the PTI still enjoys strong support, with respondents claiming that they would still vote for PTI in the next elections. With increasing austerity under the IMF structural adjustment programme, the PTI's popularity will be tested in the coming years. The crackdown on PTM, a peaceful movement, is a lost opportunity for this government. Addressing the grievances of PTM supporters could have been instrumental in uniting citizens across ethnic lines, in parts of the country that have previously been ignored if not violated. This lost opportunity is indicative of a security state that can only tolerate one national narrative that is under its control. The crackdown on human rights activists, journalists and free speech in general will continue under